NATIONAL WORKFORCE INTEGRITY & MARKET ANALYSIS

Australian Construction Market Research

Quantifying the $1.2B Software Opportunity, Policy Reform, and the ProjMan Evidence Layer

Executive Summary & Core Market Insight: The Australian residential construction sector faces a severe, structural skilled labor shortfall of 130,000+ workers alongside an estimated 18,000 trade-qualified migrants operating below their skill capacity. Traditional Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) credentialing is a $10,000, 18-month 'brick wall' tainted by high ASQA audit fraud risks. This research paper evaluates the $1.2B+ Australian construction software market, analyzing why existing operations tools (Buildxact, Procore) and AI code lookup engines (Legis-Link) fail to solve the credentialing crisis. ProjMan and VeriTrade capture an unoccupied market territory by converting daily building tasks into an immutable, multi-party verified *Verified Work History*, directly aligning with state financial oversight legislation and the Federal Government's $78M Advanced Entry Trades program.

1. Macroeconomic Reality & Skilled Labor Crisis

The Australian construction sector employs approximately **1.3 million workers** (accounting for 9% of the total national workforce) across more than 400,000 registered businesses. According to Deloitte Access Economics and Master Builders Australia, **83% of construction firms report acute difficulties sourcing skilled tradespeople**, creating an immediate deficit of 130,000 workers to meet national housing targets (235,000 dwellings currently under construction).

Crucially, roughly **35% of the active construction workforce (~455,000 workers) operates without formal trade qualifications**. These are highly competent, experienced trade assistants, handymen, and site laborers who carry out structural tasks daily but are trapped by systemic barriers in the vocational education system. Furthermore, over **18,000 trade-qualified migrants** are working below their skill levels due to fractured overseas qualification recognition frameworks.

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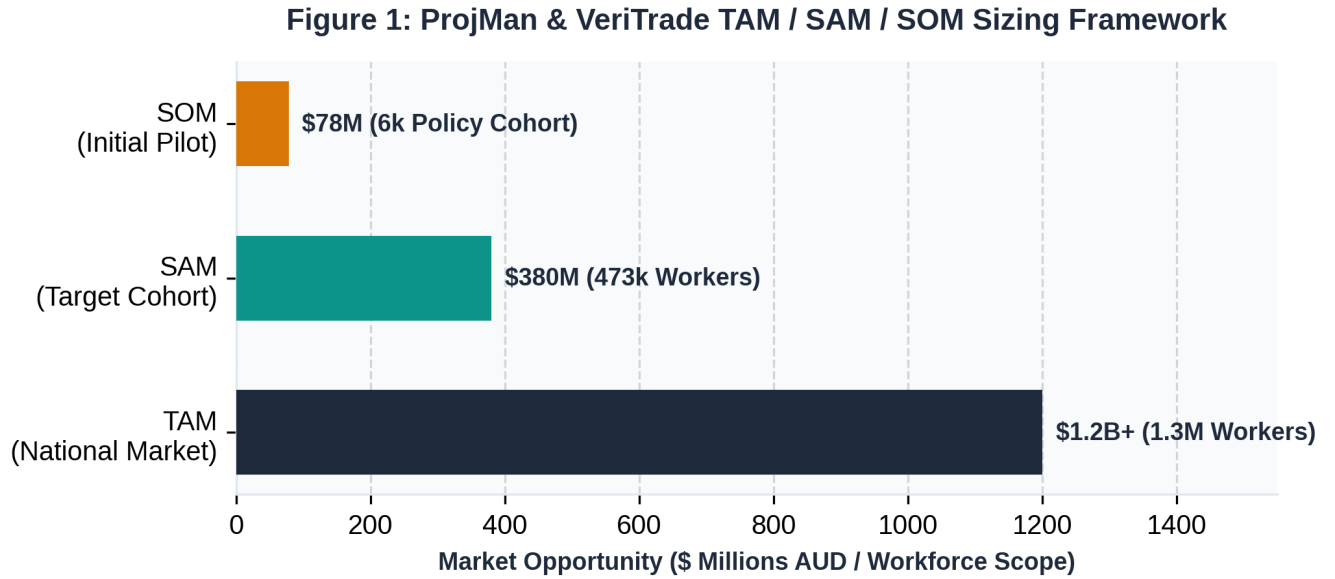


Figure 1: ProjMan & VeriTrade TAM / SAM / SOM Market Sizing Breakdown (2026).

2. Competitive Software Landscape: The Unoccupied Niche

The Australian construction software industry ($1.2B+ TAM) is currently bifurcated into two distinct lanes, neither of which addresses worker credentialing or verifiable evidence:

Software Vendor	Origin & Model	Published Pricing (2026)	Core Product Focus	Evidence Architecture
Buildxact	AU (Per Business)	$199/mo ($169 annual)	Estimating-led, takeoffs, price lists	Employer-bound, no worker portability
Buildertrend	US (Volume-based)	Quote only (~US$399/mo)	Financials, CRM, client portal	Project logs, no trade attestations
Procore	US (Custom Tier)	Quote only (~US$10,000+/yr)	Tier-1/2 Commercial operations	Corporate compliance, heavy admin
Legis-Link MCP	AU (Per Query)	Free / $199/yr Pro	AI Plain-English NCC/AS standards	Off-site advisory, no lifecycle engine
AmpleCheck AI	AU (Subscription)	Subscription	NCC floor plan checks & AI models	Drawing pre-check, no hold point gates
ProjMan / VeriTrade	AU (SaaS B2B)	Free Supply / B2B Tier	18-Stage Evidence Engine & VeriTrade	Multi-party immutable Verified History

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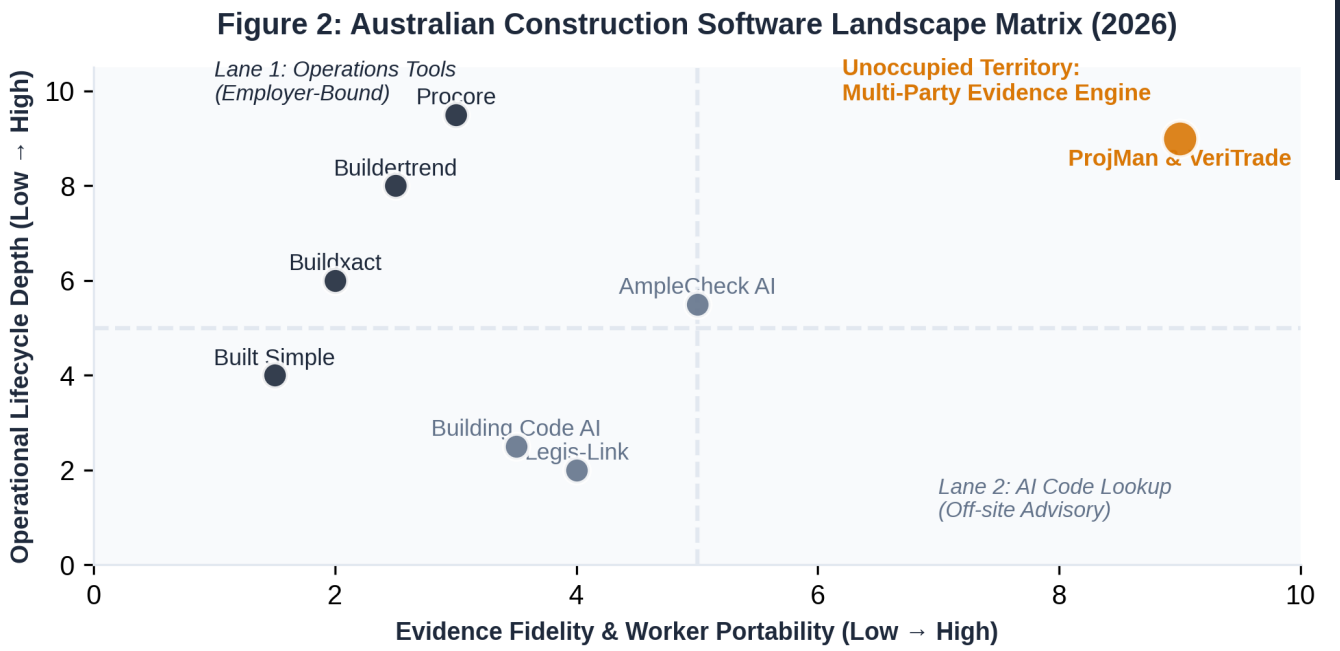


Figure 2: Australian Construction Software Positioning Matrix (Lane 1 vs Lane 2 vs ProjMan).

3. Regional Shortages & Policy Tailwinds

Data from the Housing Industry Association (HIA Q2 2026 Trades Report) reveals that trade shortages are acute across all major markets, with regional Western Australia (-1.54) and regional Queensland (-1.15) suffering the most severe deficits. By trade specialty, bricklaying (-1.02), ceramic tiling (-0.96), roofing (-0.83), and carpentry (-0.80) represent the steepest deficits.

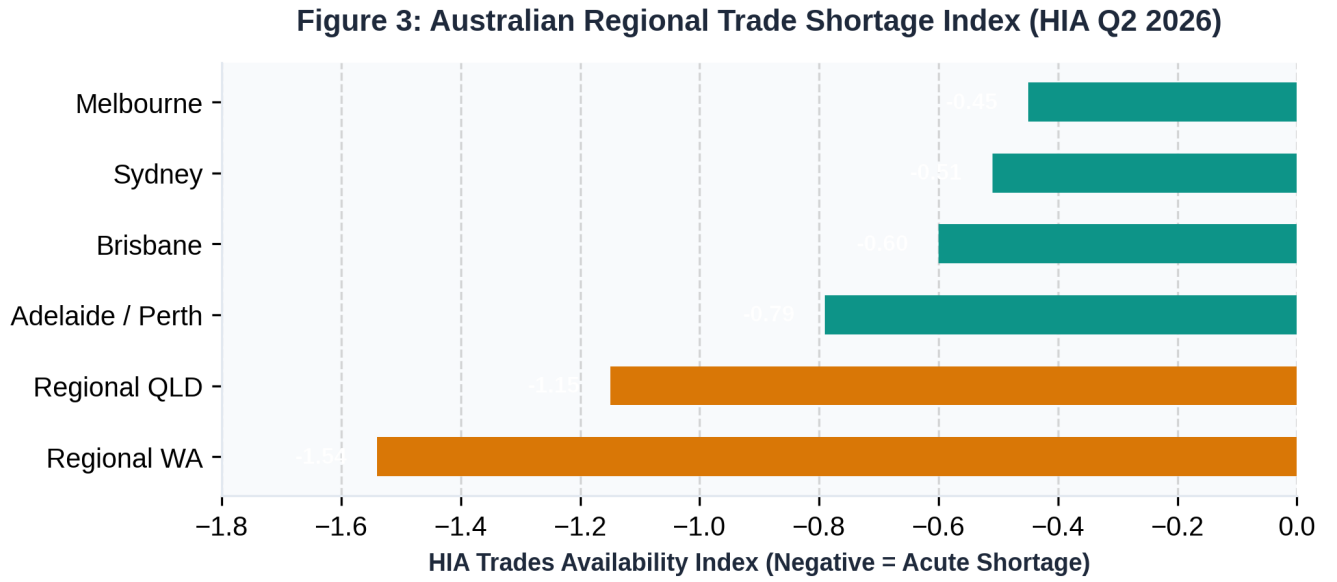


Figure 3: HIA Trades Availability Index across Australian Regions (Q2 2026).

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The Australian Skills Quality Authority (ASQA) has initiated an unprecedented regulatory enforcement campaign, cancelling over 30,000 fraudulent qualifications and investigating 158 providers. Traditional RPL is broken because it relies on subjective employer statutory declarations that are easily forged yet extremely difficult for genuine migrants to obtain. ProjMan replaces this forensic burden by capturing geofenced, timestamped evidence as a natural byproduct of daily work.

Figure 4: RPL Pathway Economic Transformation (Traditional vs. ProjMan)

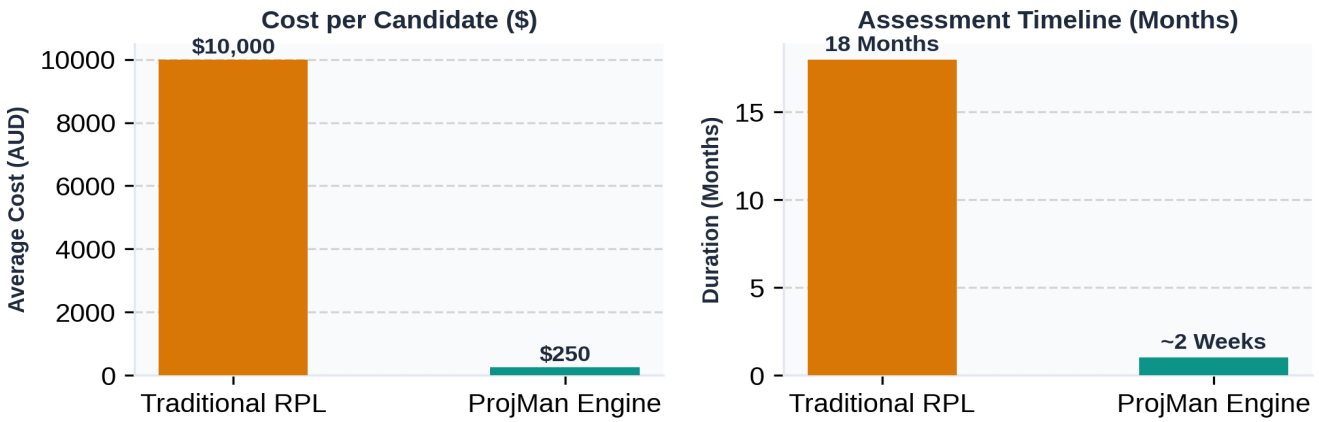


Figure 4: RPL Pathway Transformation — Cost and Assessment Duration Comparison.

5. Monetisation Architecture & B2B Strategy

VeriTrade operates on a frictionless B2B supply-and-demand monetisation architecture. Supply-side trade workers and migrants register and build their *Verified Work History* **free forever**, eliminating adoption friction. Commercial builders, Tier-1 contractors, and RTO assessors pay B2B SaaS subscriptions to search, discover, and verify candidate profiles backed by unforgeable site sign-offs and live state licensing registry checks.

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